

D320

Managing Cloud Security

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A marketing agency with 150 staff uses a SaaS customer relationship platform with a strong industry reputation. An auditor finds that three former employees still have active accounts on the platform. Who is responsible for fixing this?

- A. The agency
- B. The SaaS provider
- C. The provider, because SaaS always shifts all security to the vendor
- D. The auditor

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In which service model is the customer responsible for patching the guest operating system?

- A. SaaS
- B. IaaS
- C. All three models
- D. PaaS

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A fintech startup based in Miami has five cloud engineers who share one root administrator login so on-call handoffs go smoothly. The company plans to double its staff next year. What should the security manager do?

- A. Give every engineer full admin rights on their own accounts.
- B. Give each engineer an individual account with role-based permissions and MFA, and lock away the root account.
- C. Wait until hiring doubles to redesign access.
- D. Keep the shared login but change the password monthly.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A clinic network with 30 locations is leaving its IaaS provider after eight years. Its patient data sits on the provider's shared storage, encrypted with keys the clinic controls. The contract ends in 60 days. How can the clinic best ensure the data is unrecoverable?

- A. Keep paying for storage so no one else gets the drives.
- B. Degauss the provider's drives.
- C. Delete the files through the console; deletion always removes data completely.
- D. Crypto-shredding: securely destroy the encryption keys after migrating the data.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A cloud-hosted order platform, which went live in 2019, is valued at \$800,000. A regional outage would damage 25% of its value, and such outages are expected once every two years. The platform team has 14 engineers. What is the annualized loss expectancy?

- A. \$200,000
- B. \$100,000
- C. \$400,000
- D. \$800,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A risk has an ALE of \$60,000. A control costing \$25,000 a year would cut the ALE to \$20,000. What is the control's net annual value?

- A. \$35,000
- B. -\$5,000
- C. \$40,000
- D. \$15,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An online retailer, which sponsors a local soccer team, buys a cyber insurance policy to cover breach response costs. The CFO signed the policy in March. Which risk treatment is this?

- A. Mitigate
- B. Avoid
- C. Transfer
- D. Accept

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company stops offering a mobile payment feature because the risk of fraud is too high. Which risk treatment is this?

- A. Avoid
- B. Mitigate
- C. Accept
- D. Transfer

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A logistics firm, which recently opened a hub in Memphis, determines that its dispatch system has a maximum tolerable downtime of 8 hours. Its proposed disaster recovery plan restores service in 12 hours with no more than 1 hour of data loss. Is the plan acceptable?

- A. Yes; any plan that restores service is acceptable.
- B. No; the RPO must equal the MTD.
- C. Yes; 1 hour of data loss is within 8 hours.
- D. No; the 12-hour RTO exceeds the 8-hour MTD.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A service has an MTD of 24 hours. Which RTO is valid for the recovery plan?

- A. 36 hours
- B. 48 hours
- C. 16 hours
- D. Any value, because RTO and MTD are unrelated

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A manufacturer with plants in Ohio and Mexico receives a legal hold notice for all email about a supplier dispute. Its cloud email system automatically deletes messages older than 2 years, and storage costs have risen 8% this year. What should the security team do?

- A.** Suspend automatic deletion for the relevant mailboxes and preserve them.
- B.** Continue the 2-year deletion schedule as normal.
- C.** Preserve only the Ohio plant's email.
- D.** Delete older mail to cut storage costs before discovery begins.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An e-commerce site processing 40,000 card payments a month wants to keep card numbers out of its own databases while still charging repeat customers. The payment team works out of Denver. Which technique fits?

- A.** Masking all but the last four digits in the database
- B.** Encryption with the key stored in the same database
- C.** Tokenization through a payment vault
- D.** Hashing the card numbers

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A marketing agency ~~with 150 staff~~ uses a SaaS customer relationship platform ~~with a strong industry reputation~~. An auditor finds that three former employees still have active accounts on the platform. Who is responsible for fixing this?

Target word: owner of user access in SaaS **Decides:** Customers always own identity and access management.

A	Correct	Account lifecycle and access stay with the customer in every model.
B	Adjacent category	The provider runs the application, not the customer's user list.
C	Absolute language	Data and access never shift.
D	Confusion set	Auditors report findings; they do not own remediation.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

In which service model is the customer responsible for patching the guest operating system?

Target word: reverse: model where the customer patches the OS **Decides:** Only IaaS leaves the OS with the customer.

A	Inverted operation	The provider manages nearly everything but data and access.
B	Correct	The customer manages the OS and above.
C	Absolute language	OS patching moves to the provider in PaaS and SaaS.
D	Adjacent category	The provider patches the OS; the customer manages code and data.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A fintech startup ~~based in Miami~~ has five cloud engineers who share one root administrator login so on-call handoffs go smoothly. ~~The company plans to double its staff next year.~~ What should the security manager do?

Target word: fix a shared privileged account **Decides:** Shared credentials break accountability and least privilege.

A	Absolute language	Individual accounts help, but blanket admin rights break least privilege.
B	Correct	Individual identities, least privilege, and MFA restore accountability.
C	Camouflage	Future headcount does not justify current risk.
D	Dropped element	Rotation does not fix shared, untraceable use.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A clinic network ~~with 30 locations~~ is leaving its IaaS provider ~~after eight years~~. Its patient data sits on the provider's shared storage, encrypted with keys the clinic controls. ~~The contract ends in 60 days.~~ How can the clinic best ensure the data is unrecoverable?

Target word: data destruction in the cloud **Decides:** Physical media cannot be reached; the clinic controls the keys.

A	Inverted operation	Extends exposure instead of destroying the data.
B	Adjacent category	The customer has no access to shared physical media.
C	Absolute language	Deleted blocks may persist on shared media.
D	Correct	Without the keys, the encrypted data cannot be read.

5. Answer B Concept 4

A cloud-hosted order platform, ~~which went live in 2019~~, is valued at \$800,000. A regional outage would damage 25% of its value, and such outages are expected once every two years. ~~The platform team has 14 engineers.~~ What is the annualized loss expectancy?

Target word: ALE **Decides:** $SLE = \$800,000 \times 0.25 = \$200,000$; $ARO = 0.5$.

A	Dropped element	That is the SLE; the ARO is left out.
B	Correct	$\$200,000 \times 0.5 = \$100,000$.
C	Inverted operation	Divides SLE by 0.5 instead of multiplying.
D	Wrong stem number	The full asset value.

6. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

A risk has an ALE of \$60,000. A control costing \$25,000 a year would cut the ALE to \$20,000. What is the control's net annual value?

Target word: cost-benefit of a control **Decides:** $Value = (ALE \text{ before} - ALE \text{ after}) - \text{annual control cost}$.

A	Confusion set	$\$60,000 - \$25,000$ ignores the remaining ALE.
B	Inverted operation	Compares the remaining ALE to the cost instead of the reduction.
C	Dropped element	Leaves out the control's cost.
D	Correct	$(\$60,000 - \$20,000) - \$25,000 = \$15,000$.

7. Answer C Concept 5

An online retailer, ~~which sponsors a local soccer team~~, buys a cyber insurance policy to cover breach response costs. ~~The CFO signed the policy in March.~~ Which risk treatment is this?

Target word: name the treatment **Decides:** Insurance shifts financial impact to a third party.

A	Confusion set	Mitigation lowers likelihood or impact with controls; insurance does neither.
B	Inverted operation	Avoidance stops the activity entirely.
C	Correct	Insurance transfers the financial loss.
D	Adjacent category	Acceptance takes no action beyond acknowledging the risk.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

A company stops offering a mobile payment feature because the risk of fraud is too high. Which risk treatment is this?

Target word: name the treatment from the action **Decides:** Ending the risky activity.

A	Correct	Removing the activity removes the risk.
B	Adjacent category	Would keep the feature with added controls.
C	Confusion set	Would keep the feature with no change.
D	Inverted operation	Would keep the activity and shift the loss to someone else.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A logistics firm, ~~which recently opened a hub in Memphis,~~ determines that its dispatch system has a maximum tolerable downtime of 8 hours. Its proposed disaster recovery plan restores service in 12 hours with no more than 1 hour of data loss. Is the plan acceptable?

Target word: check RTO against MTD **Decides:** The 12-hour RTO exceeds the 8-hour MTD.

A	Absolute language	Recovery must beat the MTD.
B	Adjacent category	RPO measures data loss, not downtime.
C	Confusion set	Compares RPO to MTD; the RTO is the problem.
D	Correct	RTO must be shorter than MTD.

10. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

A service has an MTD of 24 hours. Which RTO is valid for the recovery plan?

Target word: choose a valid RTO **Decides:** RTO must be below MTD.

A	Inverted operation	Exceeds the MTD.
B	Wrong stem number	Doubles the MTD.
C	Correct	Below the 24-hour MTD, leaving a margin.
D	Absolute language	RTO must fit inside MTD.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A manufacturer ~~with plants in Ohio and Mexico~~ receives a legal hold notice for all email about a supplier dispute. Its cloud email system automatically deletes messages older than 2 years, ~~and storage costs have risen 8% this year.~~ What should the security team do?

Target word: action under a legal hold **Decides:** A legal hold suspends normal deletion for relevant data.

A	Correct	Destroying held data can be spoliation.
B	Inverted operation	The hold overrides routine retention.
C	Dropped element	The hold covers all relevant email, wherever stored.
D	Camouflage	Cost is irrelevant and deletion could be illegal.

12. Answer C Concept 8

An e-commerce site ~~processing 40,000 card payments a month~~ wants to keep card numbers out of its own databases while still charging repeat customers. ~~The payment team works out of Denver.~~ Which technique fits?

Target word: choose the data protection technique **Decides:** Real numbers must stay out of its systems yet remain usable through a vault.

A	Adjacent category	Masking is for display; the full number would still be stored.
B	Dropped element	Keeps card data in its systems and leaves out key separation.
C	Correct	Stores a random token; the real number lives in the vault.
D	Inverted operation	One-way; the card could not be charged again.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Shared responsibility across IaaS, PaaS and SaaS	The provider always secures the physical layer; the customer always owns data classification, identities, and access; the middle layers shift to the provider as you move from IaaS to PaaS to SaaS.	Assuming a SaaS provider is responsible for who in your company has access.	A service model and a question about who must fix a specific gap.
2	Identity and access management	Grant least privilege through roles, require MFA for privileged accounts, use federation or SSO so identities are managed in one place, and review access regularly.	Sharing one admin account across a team for convenience.	Several people need admin access, or an employee changes jobs.
3	Cloud data lifecycle and secure destruction	Data moves through create, store, use, share, archive, and destroy; in the cloud, where physical media cannot be reached, crypto-shredding (destroying the encryption keys) is the practical way to destroy data.	Relying on degaussing or physical shredding of cloud provider drives.	Leaving a provider or deleting data on shared infrastructure.
4	Quantitative risk (ALE)	Single loss expectancy = asset value × exposure factor; annualized loss expectancy = SLE × annualized rate of occurrence.	Stopping at SLE, or dividing by ARO.	Asset value, a percentage of loss, and how often per year.
5	Risk treatment options	Avoid stops the risky activity; mitigate reduces likelihood or impact with controls; transfer shifts financial impact (insurance, contracts); accept acknowledges and budgets for the risk.	Calling cyber insurance mitigation.	An action taken on a risk and a question naming the strategy.
6	MTD, RTO and RPO	Maximum tolerable downtime is the limit before severe harm; RTO must be shorter than MTD; RPO sets how much data loss is acceptable.	Setting an RTO longer than the MTD.	Several time values and a question about which plan is valid.
7	Legal and jurisdiction concerns	Data stored in a country is subject to its laws (data sovereignty); a legal hold suspends normal deletion; eDiscovery requires being able to locate and produce data.	Deleting data under the normal retention schedule after a legal hold is issued.	Litigation, regulators, or data stored abroad.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Protecting sensitive data fields	Encryption is reversible with a key; tokenization swaps data for a random token mapped in a separate vault; masking hides part of the data for display or testing; hashing is one-way.	Calling a hash reversible, or using masking to protect stored data.	Whether the original value must be recovered and by whom.

Course scope (public description): Managing Cloud Security prepares learners to safeguard cloud data with identity and access management and to implement secure solutions in cloud service models. Learners will be introduced to skills in identifying security policies and procedures for cloud applications and in implementing operational capabilities, procedures, and training in relation to organizational needs. Learners will also gain skills in conducting risk analysis and risk management in alignment with disaster recovery and business continuity plans and in identifying legal, compliance, and ethical concerns.